



BLACK TICKET · SOC

L1 Analyst Runbook

The path a first-line analyst takes, from the alert queue to a closed case. Step by step, with screenshots.

Audience	Level 1 (L1) SOC analysts: the ANALYST role
Scope	Sign-in, start of shift, alert triage, opening and taking a case, tasks, indicators, correlation, closing
Out of scope	Administration screens (see the administrator guide), SOC lead operations
Product version	Black Ticket v1.0
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0 How to use this runbook

This is not a reference manual; it is a **route map**. It shows the order in which to handle an alert that arrives during your shift, from first look to closing summary, and which button to press at each step. Boxes mark what to watch out for.

Screen labels are written `like this`, exactly as they appear in the interface. The orange numbers on the screenshots (1) are explained in the table beneath each one.

One worked example, end to end

Every screenshot in this document comes from one real walkthrough: the Elastic SIEM alert **“Credential Access - Password Spraying Against Multiple Accounts”** was turned into a case (BT-2026-000194), investigated, given its indicators and automatically linked to two older cases. The screenshots were taken in a test environment with the `analyst1` (Test Analyst) account; case numbers and counts will differ in yours.

1 · Sign in Start-of-shift check	2 · Triage ➤ Read the alert, decide	3 · Case ➤ Open it, take it	4 · Investigate ➤ Tasks, indicators, correlation	5 · Close ➤ Verdict and summary
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What you can do as L1

You can	You cannot: ask a SOC lead
• Turn an alert into a case, merge it into an existing case, or ignore it • Take an unassigned case yourself, and release your own case • Edit, put on hold and close a case you own • Answer tasks, add indicators, link cases manually	• Assign a case to someone else • Take, edit or close a case that belongs to someone else • Change the correlation whitelist • View the audit log or open the administration screens

If you cannot see a button, it is usually because of your role (section 15).

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1 Start-of-shift checklist

The first ten minutes of every shift. The order matters: **your own work that is running out of time** first, then the queue.

- ☐ Sign in; check the marker on your profile icon (if two-factor authentication is off, turn it on).
- ☐ On the dashboard, look at **ASSIGNED TO ME**. Did the previous shift leave you anything?
- ☐ Open your cases with **Cases** → **Mine**; deal with anything **overdue** in the SLA column first.
- ☐ Open the notification bell: “has had no first response” alerts point to cases nobody has taken yet.
- ☐ Read the handover note: which case did the previous shift put on hold, and what did they ask you to watch?
- ☐ Check **ALERTS WAITING** on the dashboard and move to the alert queue (section 4).

End of shift / handover

- ☐ Is the latest state of every open case you own written down, in a task answer or in the case description?
- ☐ If the next shift must take over a case you could not finish, do not just **Release** it; tell the SOC lead so they can assign it. A released case has no owner.
- ☐ Write the alerts you **Ignore**d, and why, into the handover note (see the warning in section 5).
- ☐ For every case you put on hold (**Put on hold**), write down what you are waiting for.

How the SLA is counted

Two clocks run: **First response** stops when someone takes the case, **Resolution** stops when the case is closed. Both start from **when the incident happened** (**Incident time**), not from when the case was opened. If you turn a two-hour-old incident into a case now, two hours of the SLA are already gone. That is deliberate: the clock belongs to the incident, not to the paperwork.

The L1 flow on one card

1. Search the indicator (section 12) → if it is on an open case, **Merge**.
2. If not, **Details** → read → **Open case**.
3. **Immediately Take case**. Only then does the first-response SLA stop.
4. Answer the tasks: what you looked at, over what window, what you saw.
5. Add indicators: check the **type** and the **IOC** flag.
6. Read the correlations; escalate if needed.
7. **Close case**: the right Resolution, a three-part summary.

2 Signing in

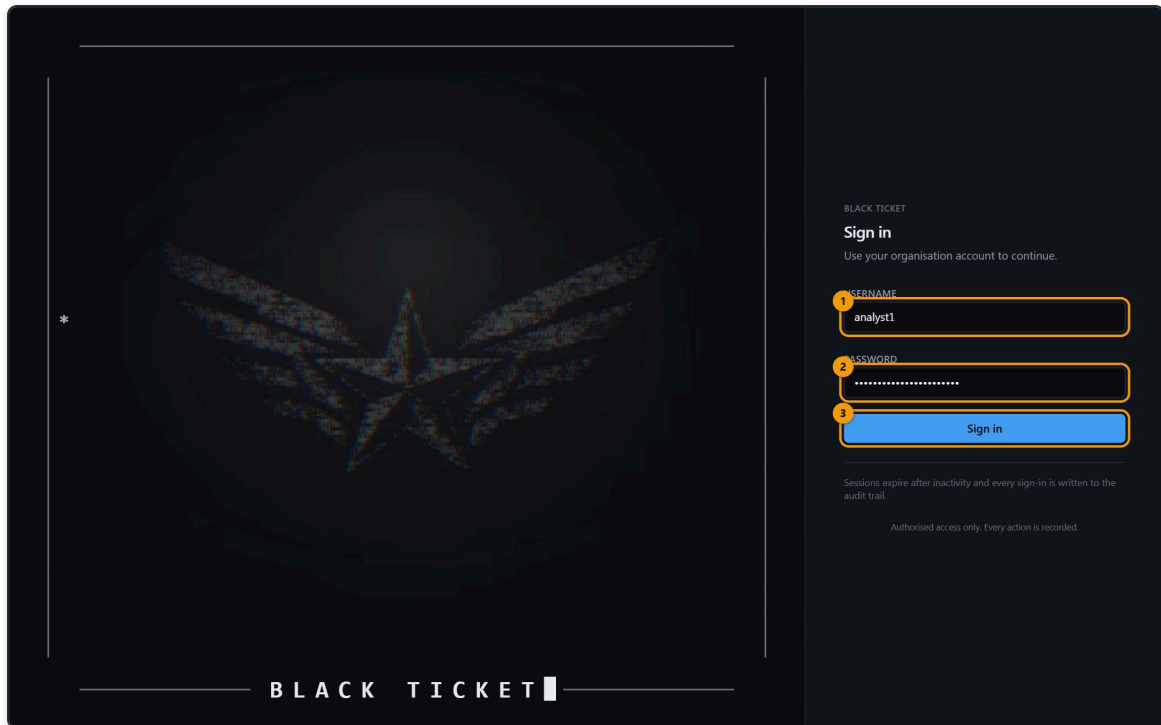


Figure 1. The sign-in screen.

1 USERNAME : your username

2 PASSWORD : your password

3 Sign in

- **On first sign-in** you are asked to change your password. The temporary password from your administrator works once.
- If two-factor authentication is on for your account, the six-digit code is asked **after** the password has been accepted. One of your recovery codes works too.
- If your organisation uses single sign-on (SSO), you will see **Sign in with your organisation account** ; you sign in with your organisation account and have no separate Black Ticket password.

Account logout

After five wrong attempts the account is locked for **15 minutes**. Every sign-in, successful or not, is written to the audit log. A session ends by itself after a period of inactivity.

3 Dashboard: reading the situation

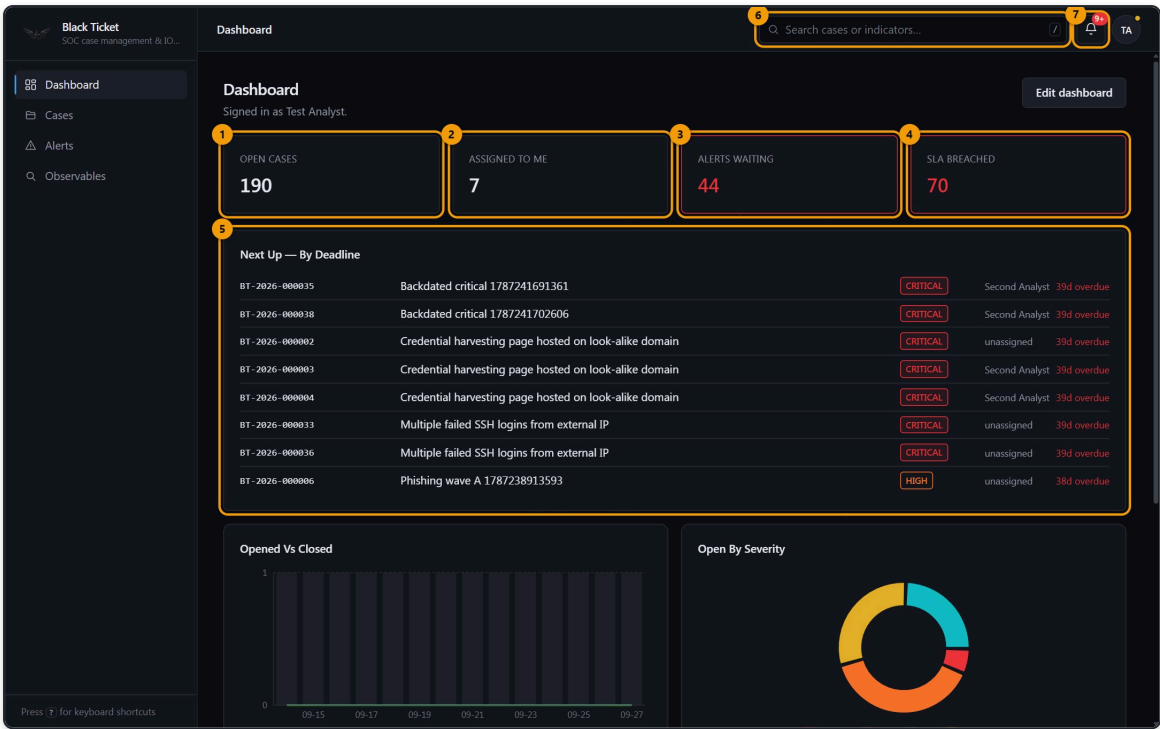


Figure 2. The dashboard. The first place to look when your shift starts.

1	OPEN CASES	All open cases
2	ASSIGNED TO ME	Open cases assigned to you. The first number to look at.
3	ALERTS WAITING	Alerts in the queue waiting for a decision
4	SLA BREACHED	Open cases that missed their SLA target
5	Next Up — By Deadline	Cases closest to their deadline; ownerless ones say <i>unassigned</i>
6	Search box	An IP, hash or domain goes to indicator search; anything else goes to case search
7	Notification bell	Unread notification count (section 16)

Every number on the dashboard is clickable

Clicking a tile, a bar or an SLA row takes you to the records behind it, and the target page shows the applied filter as a chip. You never have to rebuild the filter by hand. The dashboard is yours: add and remove widgets with `Edit dashboard`.

4 The alert queue

Alerts sent by SIEM and EDR systems collect on the `Alerts` screen. The list refreshes itself every 30 seconds. The default filter is `NEW`: alerts nobody has decided on yet.

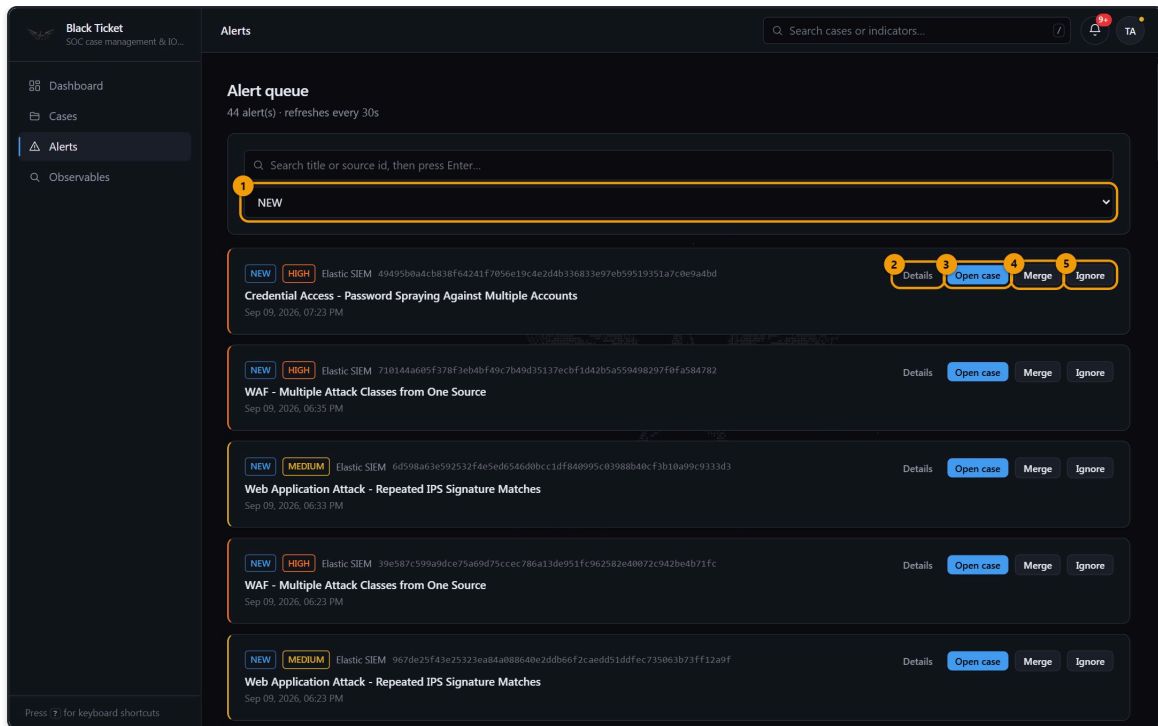


Figure 3. The alert queue. One row per alert; the left edge colour shows the severity.

1	Status filter	NEW for undecided alerts; the other statuses show history
2	Details	Expands the alert in place. Always open it before deciding.
3	Open case	Turns the alert into a new case
4	Merge	Adds the alert to an existing case
5	Ignore	Dismisses the alert without a case

If the same alert is sent twice, it is accepted once. Not seeing a duplicate is the correct behaviour.

5 Reviewing an alert and deciding

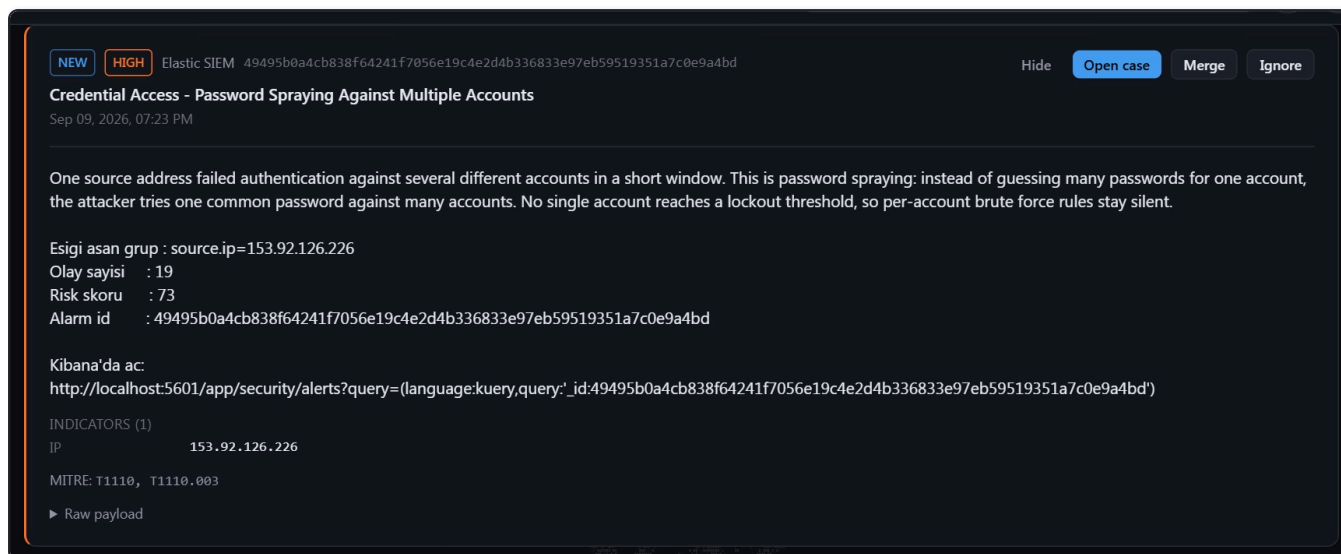


Figure 4. An alert expanded with **Details**: description, thresholds, indicators and MITRE techniques.

What to look at

1. **Description.** What did the rule catch? Here: one source tried to sign in to many different accounts in a short window (password spraying).
2. **Thresholds.** Source IP, event count, risk score. 19 events and a risk score of 73 are not explained by one mistyped password.
3. **Indicators** (**INDICATORS**). They are carried into the case as observables automatically.
4. **MITRE.** T1110.003 Password Spraying. Added to the case automatically.
5. **Source link and** **Raw payload** . To open the original event in the SIEM.

The alert text itself (for example “*Esigi asan grup*”) is written by the SIEM rule, not by Black Ticket, and appears in whatever language the rule was written in.

Decision table

Situation	Decision	Note
An open case already exists for the same attack / same source	Merge	Check this first. Opening a separate case for the second and third alert splits the work and muddies correlation.
Malicious or suspicious, needs investigating	Open case	If in doubt, open a case. Closing a case costs less than recovering a wrongly ignored alert.
Clearly known and harmless (approved scan, planned test, known broken rule)	Ignore	Only when you are sure. Read the warning below.

Open case and Ignore do not ask for confirmation

Open case creates the case the moment you click it and takes you there. **Ignore** removes the alert from the queue the moment you click it. Neither asks "are you sure?".

Ignore is recorded in the audit log with a fixed reason ("*Dismissed from the queue*"); **you cannot enter your own reason**. Write why you ignored it into the handover note. An alert that has already become a case cannot be ignored.

6 Merging into an existing case

When a second alert for the same attack arrives, add it to the existing case instead of opening a new one. Below, the second password spraying alert in the queue is being merged into BT-2026-000194, the case just opened.

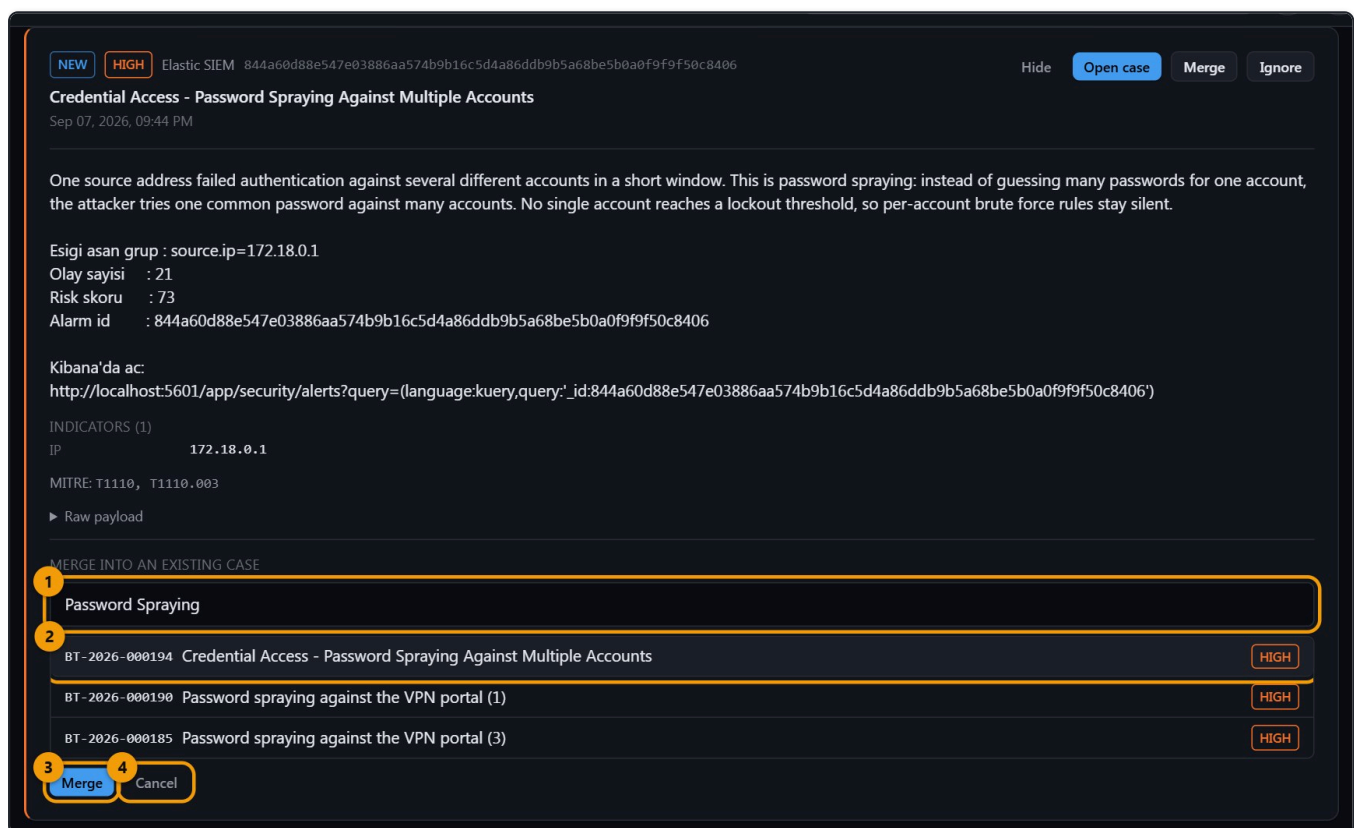


Figure 5. The merge panel that opens under the alert when you click **Merge**.

1	Search box (MERGE INTO AN EXISTING CASE)	Type a word from the case title or the case number
2	Result row	Pick the case to merge into. Check the number, title and severity.
3	Merge	Disabled until a case is selected
4	Cancel	Closes the panel; nothing changes

Merging adds the alert's indicators to the case; indicators the case **already has** are not added twice.

The same word is not the same incident

The search also returns older cases with similar titles, such as “Password spraying against the VPN portal”. Before merging, confirm that the source and the time window really are the same incident. If in doubt, choose **Open case**: if the two cases share an indicator, the system links them anyway (section 11).

7 Opening and taking a case

Open case takes you straight to the new case. A confirmation appears bottom right: “Opened BT-2026-000194 · 1 indicator(s) carried across”.

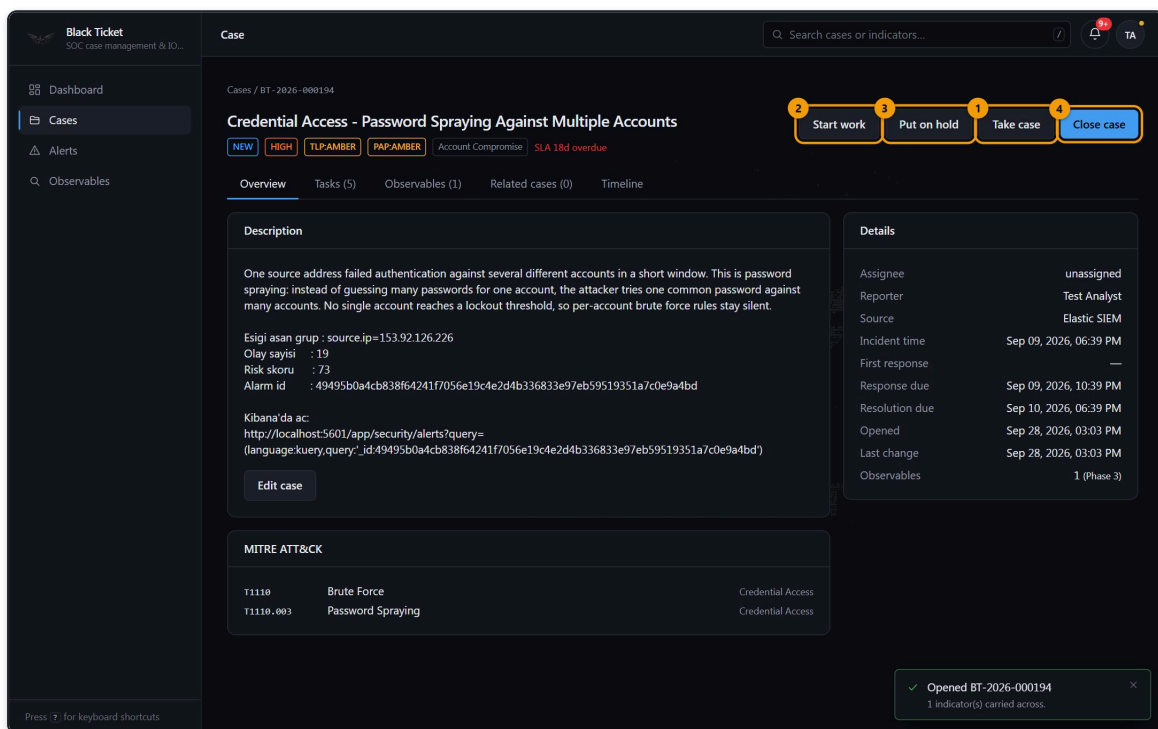


Figure 6. A case freshly opened from an alert. Status **NEW**, assignee *unassigned*.

- | | | |
|---|--------------------|---|
| 1 | Take case | Takes ownership of the case. The first thing to do after opening it. |
| 2 | Start work | Sets the status to IN PROGRESS |
| 3 | Put on hold | Sets the status to PENDING : while waiting on an outside reply |
| 4 | Close case | Opens the closing form (section 13) |

Opening a case does not assign it to you

On a case you opened from an alert you become the **Reporter**, but the **Assignee** stays empty. The case has no owner until you press **Take case**, and the first-response SLA keeps running until then.

Take case does three things

- assigns the case to you (**Assignee** : you),
- sets the status to **IN PROGRESS** by itself, so you do not also need **Start work** ,
- stamps the **First response** time: **the first-response SLA stops at this moment.**

Once taken, **Take case** is replaced by **Release** , which drops the case from you. At handover, tell the SOC lead instead of releasing it (section 1).

Because the case came from an alert, its title, severity, description, MITRE techniques and indicators were carried over. The category (**Account Compromise**) was set too, and that category's **playbook** was applied automatically, adding 5 questions (section 9).

Opening a case by hand

For a report that did not come in as an alert: **Cases** → **New case** (or the **c** key anywhere). In **Incident time** enter when the incident happened, not when you are filling in the form: the SLA starts from there.

8 Overview: the case record

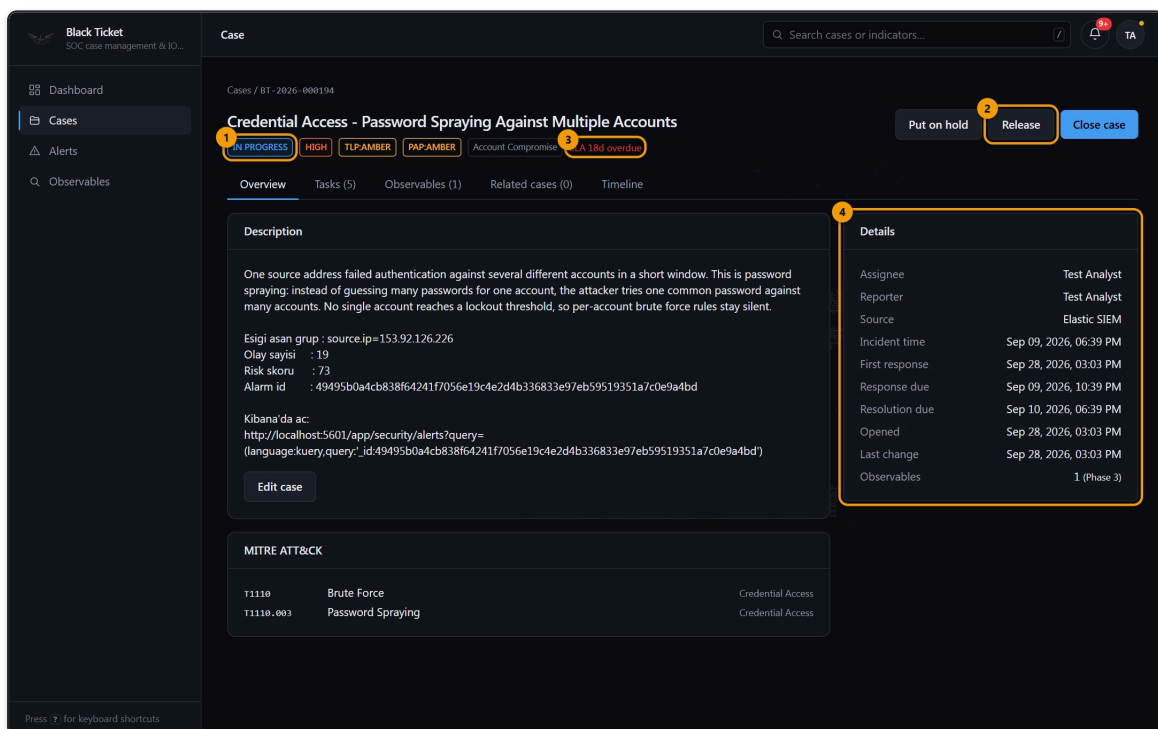


Figure 7. After **Take case** : status IN PROGRESS, assignee Test Analyst, First response filled in.

1	Status chip	NEW → IN PROGRESS. Next to it: severity, TLP, PAP and category.
2	Release	Replaces Take case once you own the case
3	SLA state	Time left, or how far past the deadline
4	Details	Assignee, incident time, First response , Response due , Resolution due

Why “18d overdue” in the example?

The alert's incident time is 9 September; the case was opened on 28 September. Because the SLA counts from the incident, the case is already late the moment it is opened. That is the cost of an alert left waiting in the queue.

TLP and PAP

Field	Meaning
TLP	Who this information may be shared with: WHITE (anyone) · GREEN (community) · AMBER (inside the organisation, need-to-know) · RED (named recipients only)
PAP	How actively the indicators may be investigated. Scanning an IP can tell the attacker they are being watched; PAP sets that limit. With PAP:AMBER or RED, ask before doing anything that touches the indicator directly.

Change the description, severity, TLP/PAP and tags with [Edit case](#). Changing the severity recalculates the SLA targets.

9 Tasks: answering the questions

Every task carries a **question**. That is the difference between a note that says “done” and a record that is still useful a month later. The questions a playbook brings depend on the kind of case; here it is *Standard triage*: Log Review, False Positive, Enterprise Search, Containment, Executive Summary.

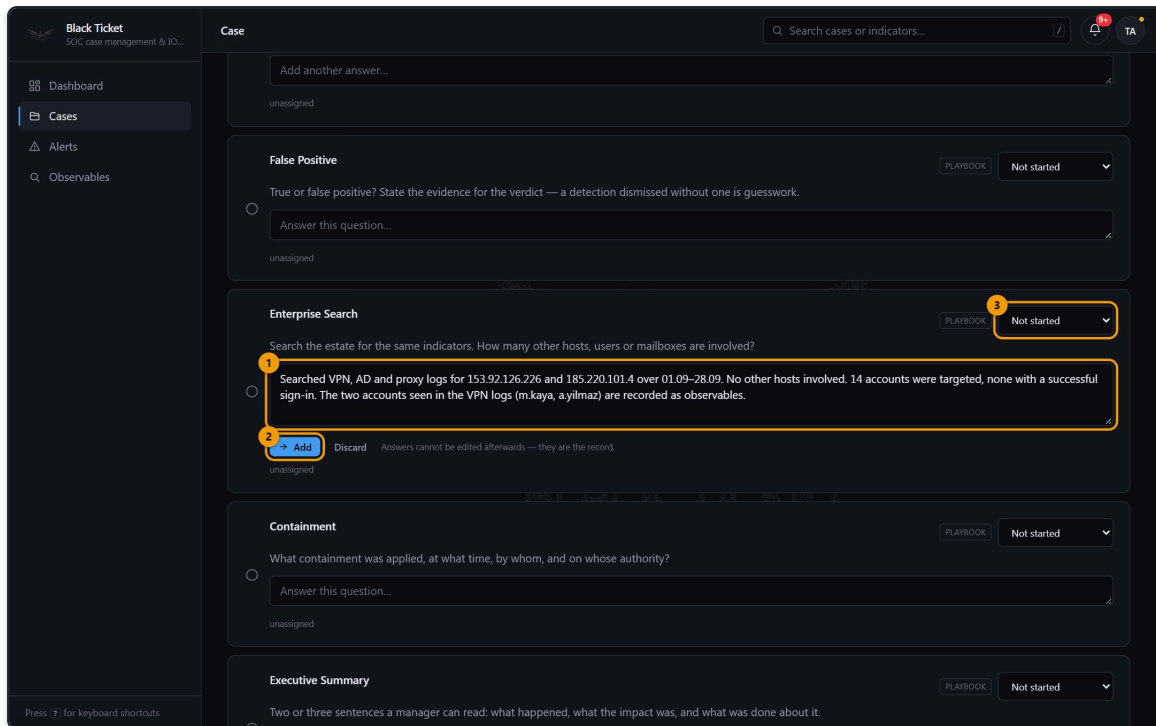


Figure 8. Writing the answer to *Enterprise Search*.

- | | | |
|---|--------------|---|
| 1 | Answer field | Type under the question. Ctrl + Enter also submits. |
| 2 | Add | Saves the answer. Discard next to it throws it away. |
| 3 | Status | Not started · In progress · Done · Not applicable |

Answers cannot be edited afterwards

The screen says so: *"Answers cannot be edited afterwards — they are the record."* If you got something wrong or left something out, add a new answer beneath it (**Add another answer...**) and say that it corrects the previous one.

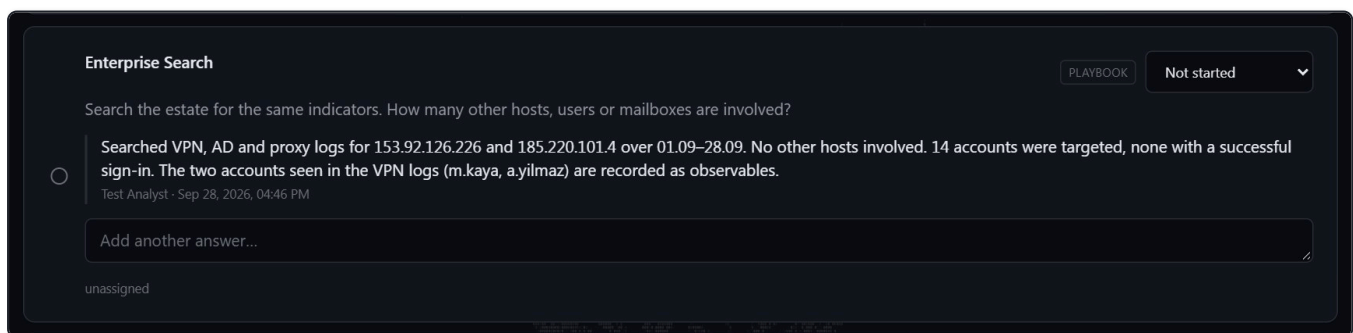


Figure 9. The saved answer, with author and time beneath it.

A good answer

Weak	Good
"Logs checked, nothing found."	"VPN (FortiGate) and AD authentication logs reviewed for 09.09 18:00–20:00. 19 failed attempts from 153.92.126.226 against 14 different accounts. No successful sign-in."

A good answer says three things: **what** was looked at, **over what window**, **what was seen**. "Nothing found" is a finding too, but nobody can rely on it unless it says where you looked.

The circle on the left shows the task's status and is also a one-click complete button. From the **Matching playbook** list at the top you can add another playbook's questions (**Add questions**), and write your own with **New task** . Applying the same playbook twice does not create duplicate questions.

10 Observables: adding indicators

Indicators (IP, domain, URL, hash, e-mail, username, file name...) are what correlation runs on: every indicator you add is compared against every other case at once.

Adding by pasting

Paste a log line, a mail header or a chat message into **PASTE ANYTHING** ; the indicators are picked out automatically. **Defanged** forms (185.220.101[.]4, hxxp://) are recognised too.

Add observables

PASTE ANYTHING

1 FortiGate VPN auth failure 09.09 18:42 — src=185.220.101[.]4 user=m.kaya result=denied
FortiGate VPN auth failure 09.09 18:43 — src=185.220.101[.]4 user=a.yilmaz result=denied

3 indicator(s) found:

IP	185.220.101.4	☒ IOC remove
2 DOMAIN	m.kaya	3 ☒ IOC remove
DOMAIN	a.yilmaz	☒ IOC remove

4 Add 3 observable(s)

OR ADD ONE DIRECTLY

IP 185.220.101[.]4 ☒ IOC Add

Figure 10. Three indicators picked out of two VPN log lines. **Two of them have the wrong type.**

1	Paste area	Paste the text as it is
2	Type selector	Check every row. m.kaya is a username, but it was recognised as a DOMAIN.
3	IOC box	Ticked by default. A victim account is not malicious; untick it.
4	Add 3 observable(s)	Adds them all once you have checked them

Two checks before adding

- **Type.** Usernames containing a dot (m.kaya, a.yilmaz) are mistaken for domain names. Correct the type to **USERNAME**. A wrong type means the indicator is looked for in the wrong place during correlation.
- **IOC flag.** **IOC** means "this is malicious", not "this was seen in the incident". Every pasted or individually added indicator arrives flagged as IOC. Untick it for **victim accounts, our own servers and legitimate services** (e.g. login.microsoft.com). Indicators that came with the alert are the other way round: they arrive **unflagged**; flag them yourself once you have confirmed they are malicious.

Adding one at a time

On the **OR ADD ONE DIRECTLY** row, **type the value first, then choose the type**. While you type, the system guesses the type and overwrites whatever you chose before; if you pick the type first, m.kaya is still added as a DOMAIN. Glance at the type box once more before pressing **Add**.

The indicator table

Observables (4)						
TYPE	VALUE	IOC	TLP	SEEN ON	ADDED	
IP	153.92.126.226	☒	AMBER	1 case(s)	Test · Sep 28, 2026	remove
IP	185.220.101.4	☒	AMBER	3 case(s)	Test · Sep 28, 2026	remove
USERNAME	m.kaya	☐	AMBER	1 case(s)	Test · Sep 28, 2026	remove
USERNAME	a.yilmaz	☐	AMBER	1 case(s)	Test · Sep 28, 2026	remove

Figure 11. The corrected table: attacker IPs are IOC, victim accounts are USERNAME and not IOC.

- 1

IOC

The malicious flag; can be toggled from the table too
- 2

SEEN ON

How many cases the indicator appears on. **More than 1** means it is on other cases too (section 11).
- 3

TLP

The sharing limit for this indicator
- 4

remove

Removes the indicator from the case. **No confirmation.**

11 Correlation and related cases

If an indicator you add is also on another case, the system links the two cases **automatically** and tells you with a yellow notice as you add it. In the example: *“Added 3. 2 correlation(s): BT-2026-000010, BT-2026-000006”*. The address 185.220.101.4 had already been seen on two phishing cases in August.

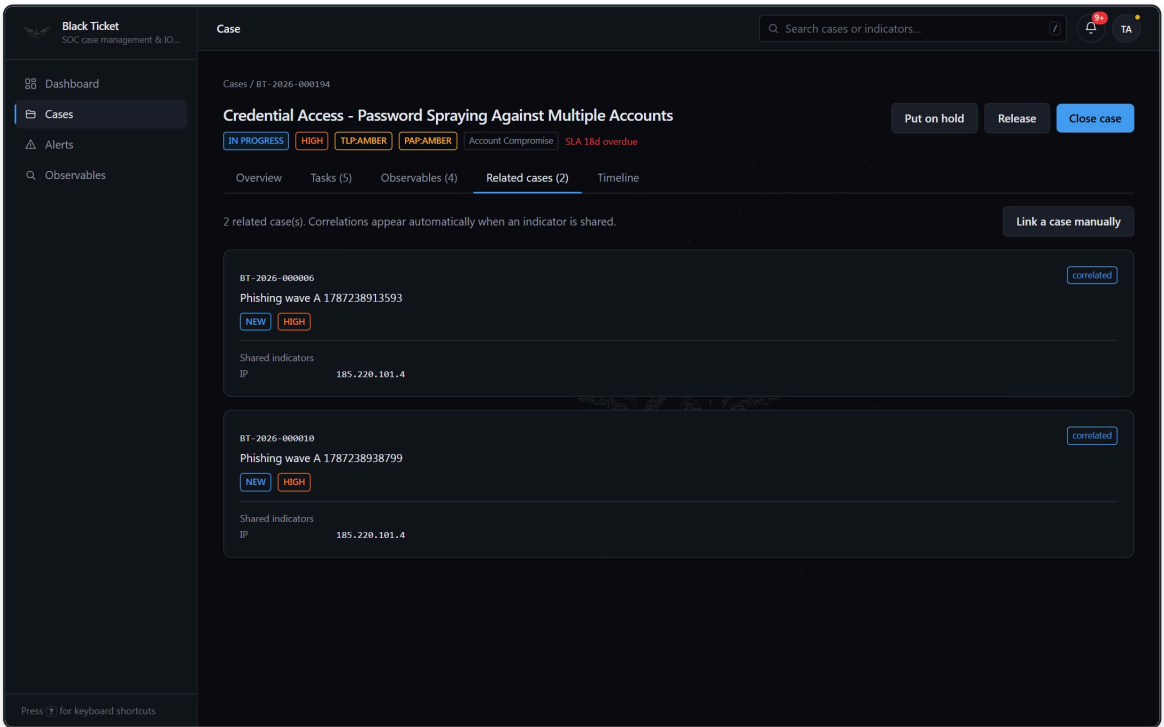


Figure 12. **Related cases (2)**: two older cases, each with the shared indicator.

- Each related case card shows the **correlated** label and, under **Shared indicators**, **which indicator** they have in common.
- If cases are related without sharing an indicator, link them with **Link a case manually**; you are asked for a **reason**.

What to do when a correlation appears

- Open and read the related cases: same actor, same campaign, or coincidence?
- If a related case is **open and owned by someone else**, tell its owner. The correlation may mean two analysts are working the same incident separately.
- If the shared indicator is “noise”, such as the organisation's own egress IP, tell the SOC lead; once whitelisted it will not link cases again.
- Write your finding into the relevant task (in the example, *Enterprise Search*).

Timeline

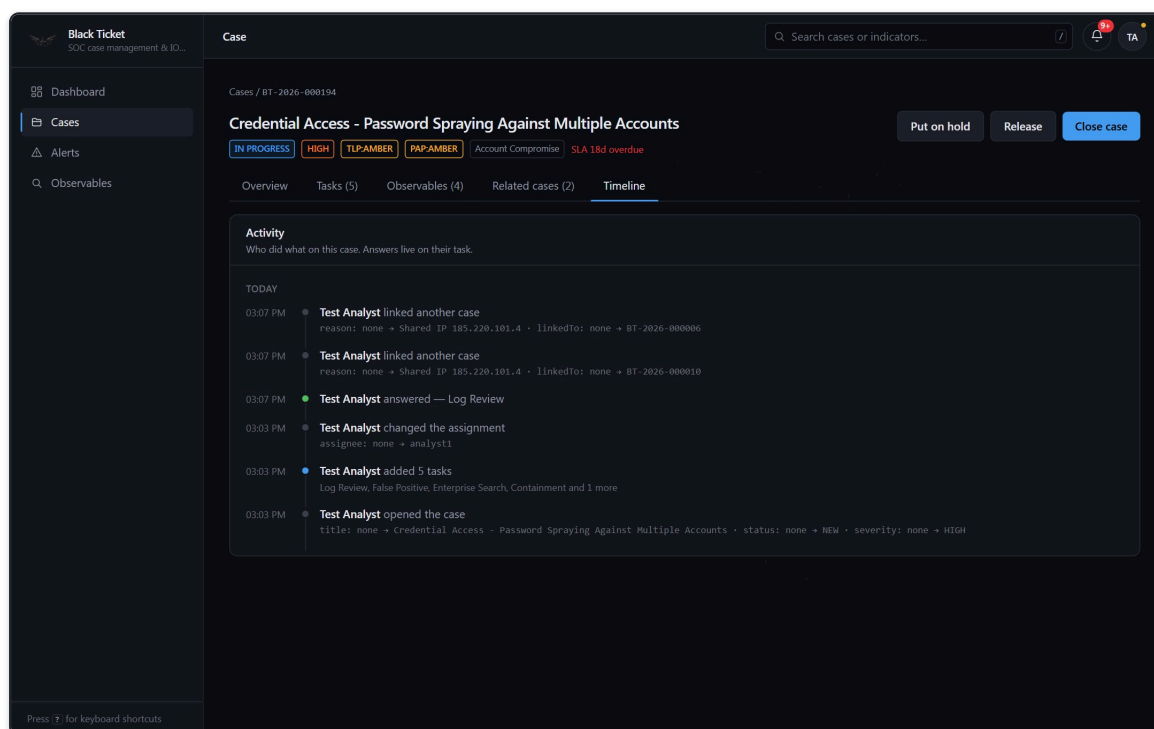


Figure 13. **Timeline**: who did what on the case, and when. Automatic links are recorded with their reason (“Shared IP 185.220.101.4”).

The timeline shows activity only; the answer texts stay on their tasks. When you take over a case, read its timeline first.

12 Searching indicators across all cases

The fastest answer to “has this IP hit us before?”: the **Observables** screen searches **across every case**. Typing an IP, hash or domain into the top-bar search box brings you here too.

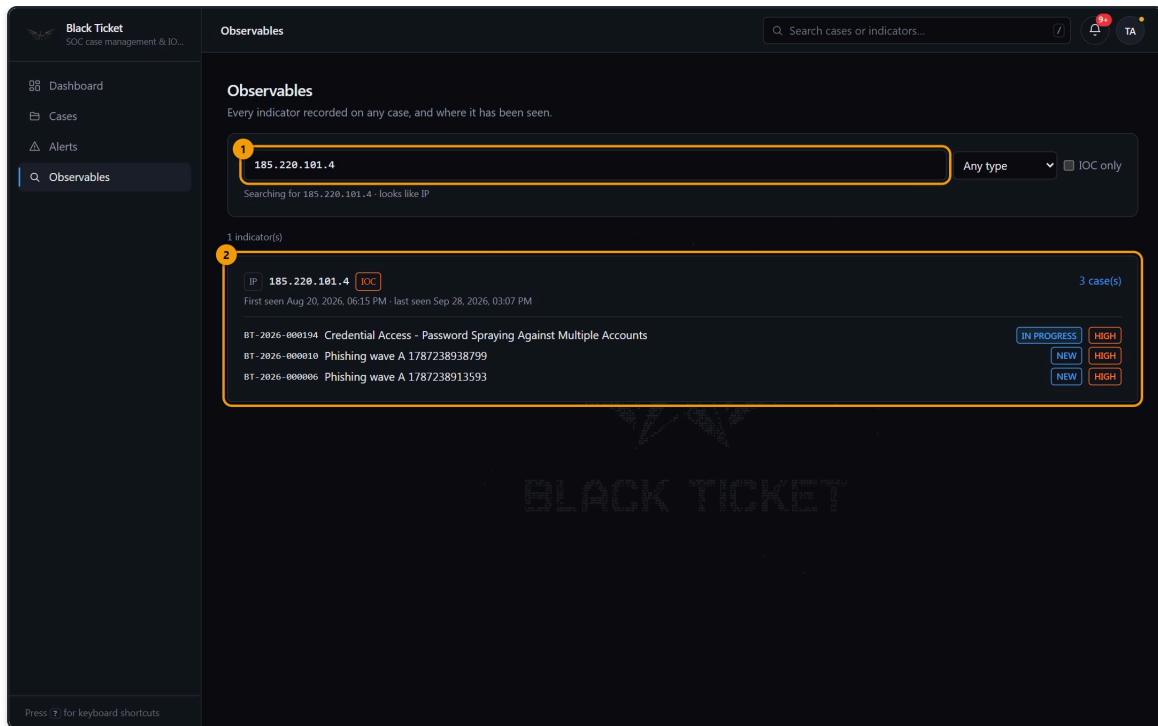


Figure 14. Searching 185.220.101.4: IOC, first and last seen, 3 cases.

- 1 Search box Type the value; the system guesses its type (*looks like IP*). Narrow with **Any type** and **IOC only**.
- 2 Result card **First seen / last seen** and every case the indicator appears on, with status and severity

When to use it

For every new alert, search the main indicator **before** opening a case. If it is already on an open case, the right decision is most likely **Merge**. If it is on closed cases, their closing summaries will save you time.

13 Closing the case

Before closing

- ☐ Is every task answered or marked **Not applicable**?
- ☐ Are the indicator types and IOC flags right?
- ☐ Have the related cases been read and, where needed, their owners told?
- ☐ If an action beyond your authority was needed (blocking, password reset, device isolation), was it escalated (section 14)?

Figure 15. The `Close case` form.

1	<code>RESOLUTION</code>	The verdict, per the table below
2	<code>CLOSING SUMMARY</code>	<i>What happened, what was done, what the next shift needs to know.</i>
3	<code>Close case</code>	Closes the case; the Resolution SLA stops
4	<code>Cancel</code>	Closes the form; nothing changes

Resolution	When to choose it
<code>TRUE POSITIVE</code>	Malicious or unauthorised activity really took place. An attack attempt belongs here even if it failed.
<code>FALSE POSITIVE</code>	The rule fired wrongly; the activity it describes did not happen. Give the rule owner feedback.
<code>BENIGN</code>	The activity is real but harmless and expected: an approved vulnerability scan, a planned test, an authorised admin action.
<code>DUPLICATE</code>	A copy of another case. Say which case in the summary; link it manually if needed.
<code>INDETERMINATE</code>	Not enough evidence to decide (no logs, retention expired). Say what is missing.

Example closing summary

"External password spraying (153.92.126.226, 185.220.101.4). 14 accounts targeted, no successful sign-in. Both IPs blocked on the FortiGate; password reset enforced for the affected accounts. Next shift: watch VPN attempts from the same sources for 48 hours."

What happened, what was done, what the next shift needs to know: all three are there.

A closed case can be reopened with `Reopen`, which is also recorded. To change anything on a closed case, reopen it first.

Putting a case on hold: while waiting for an outside reply (from the user, logs from another team), set the case to `PENDING` with `Put on hold` and write down what you are waiting for. When the reply arrives, carry on with `Start work`.

14 Escalation: when to take it up a level

L1's job is not to solve every case to the end; it is to get the right case to the right person **in time**. The triggers below are a suggested starting point. **Your organisation's escalation procedure and contact channel take precedence**; adapt this table to them.

Trigger	What to do
Severity CRITICAL	Open the case, take it, and tell the SOC lead without waiting
Any sign of a successful compromise (successful sign-in, running malware, data leaving)	Escalate immediately; containment decisions are not L1's to make
An action such as blocking, password reset or device isolation is needed	Request the action; record who approved it in the <i>Containment</i> task
Correlation shows the same indicator on more than one open case	Possible campaign: tell the SOC lead and let the case owners know
You will miss the SLA and know you cannot make it	Say so before the deadline; the lead can reassign
Work is needed on someone else's case	You cannot take it: the SOC lead assigns
You are not sure	Ask. A case closed without asking costs more than a question asked.

What to say when escalating

The case number, a one-sentence summary, why you are escalating and what you have done so far. The detail is already in the case: task answers, indicators, timeline. On a well-kept case, an escalation is a number and a sentence.

15 “Why can't I do this?”

Situation	Reason / fix
No Take case on someone else's case	Analysts can only take unassigned cases; the SOC lead assigns
Status buttons (Put on hold ...) are greyed out	The case is not yours. Only its owner or a SOC lead can change it.
I cannot correct my answer	By design: answers are the record. Correct it with a new answer beneath.
My username was added as a DOMAIN	Type the value first, then choose the type (section 10). Take the wrong one out with remove and add it again.
I cannot ignore an imported alert	The alert has already become a case
The same alert does not appear twice	Correct behaviour: the source + identifier pair is unique
I cannot edit a closed case	Reopen it first; that is recorded too
I cannot see the Administration menu	Your role has no administration rights
I cannot sign in with a password; it says “ <i>Sign in with your organisation account</i> ”	Your organisation has moved to SSO; sign in with your organisation account
My account is locked	After five wrong attempts, wait 15 minutes or contact your administrator

Where you get stuck, the message on screen usually gives the reason too. If it does not, ask a SOC lead or an administrator: every action is in the audit log, so what happened can always be found.

16 My cases, notifications, shortcuts

The case list

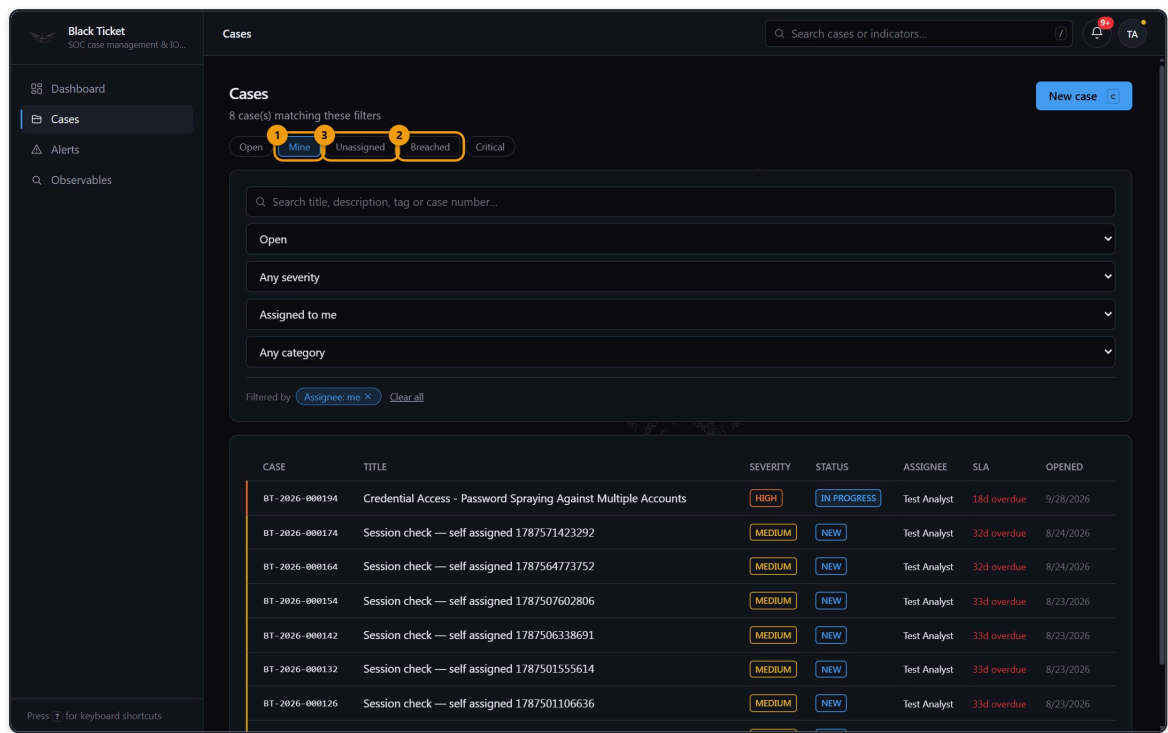


Figure 16. The Cases screen with the Mine filter on.

- 1

Mine

Cases assigned to you. The active filter shows below as Assignee: me ; Clear all removes it.
- 2

Breached

Cases that missed their SLA
- 3

Unassigned

Cases with no owner: work you can take

Notifications

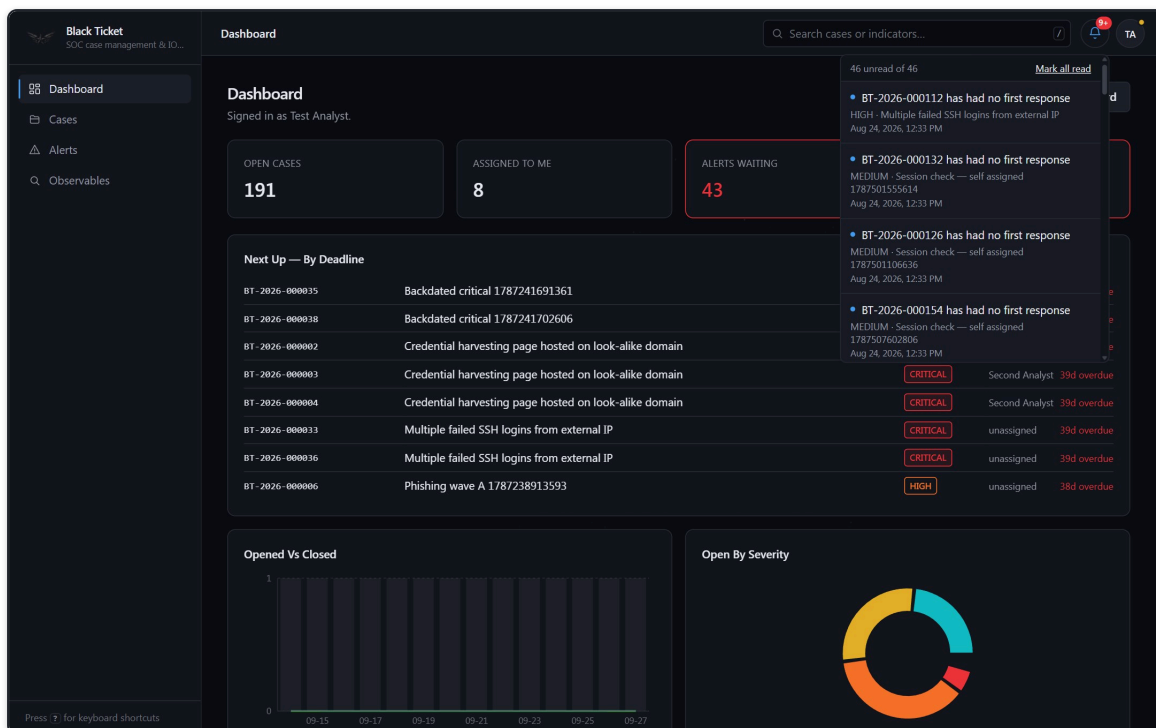


Figure 17. The notification list. *"has had no first response"*: nobody has taken the case yet.

Notifications are raised when a case is assigned to you, when a case you own misses its SLA, for cases nobody has taken, and when the alert queue passes its threshold. If your organisation has set up outbound e-mail, the same events arrive by e-mail too. **Mark all read** clears them. You are not notified about a case you took yourself.

Keyboard shortcuts

Key	Action
/	Focus the search box
c	New case
g then d	Dashboard
g then c	Cases
g then a	Alerts
g then o	Observables
?	Shortcut help
Esc	Close menus and dialogs

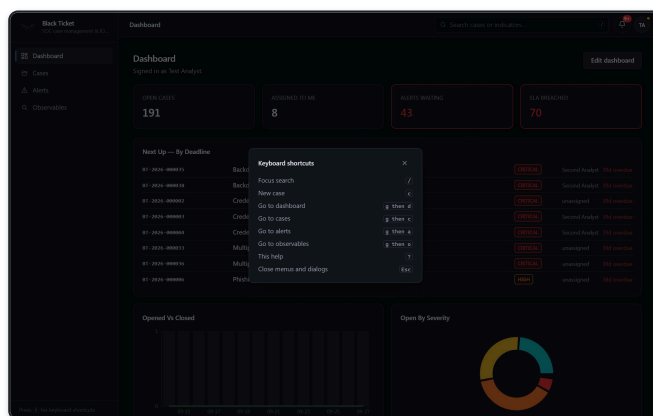


Figure 18. The help window opened with **?**.

Shortcuts do not fire while a text field has focus; typing "c" in the search box does not open a form.